

Food assistance needs remain high in southeastern pastoral areas

Key Messages

- Dollo and Korahe zones in Somali Region are expected to remain in Crisis (IPC Phase 3) through January 2019. The number of poor households facing Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes is expected to rise through the end of the dry season in September, but outcomes are likely to start improving with camel milk production in October. Stressed (IPC Phase 2) outcomes are projected to persist in eastern Amhara, Tigray, Afar, and southeastern Ethiopia; in many areas, outcomes would be worse in the absence of assistance. Meanwhile, conflict-induced displacement is expected to continue disrupting food and income access among IDPs and drive increased humanitarian assistance needs.
- Cumulative *Kiremt* rainfall between June 1 to July 20 was five to 45 percent above average across most western and central areas. This has led to favorable cropping conditions and total *Meher* production is likely to be average. However, in parts of eastern Amhara and southern Tigray, a nearly 20-day delay in *Kiremt* rainfall, following a poor performance of the *Belg* rains in these same areas, is likely to affect *Meher* production prospects.
- In northern pastoral areas of Ethiopia, the *Karan/Karma* (July to September) rainy season has begun after about a 20-day delay in northern Afar Region. According to remote sensing products, vegetation conditions remain below average, particularly after the previous poor rainy season, but pasture and water availability are expected to improve with the forecasted average rainfall for the rest of the season. As a result, livestock body conditions and productivity are expected to improve.
- Recurring and new conflict continues to drive significant displacement, negatively affecting household access to food and income sources from the current *Belg* and/or *Meher* seasons, as well as pastoral activities. According to IOM, the largest recent displacement has occurred in Gedeo Zone of SNNPR since June, where over 822,000 people have been internally displaced within the Zone to various IDP camps and host communities. In addition, more than 147,000 people have been internally displaced in West Guji in Oromia. In these areas, as well as along parts of the Somali and Oromia regional borders, the majority of IDPs are reliant on humanitarian assistance.
- According to WFP, as of July 10, food assistance delivery in Somali Region for the first and second rounds of distributions are 78 and 31 percent complete, respectively. Typically at this time of year, food aid delivery for the fourth round is beginning. Given the current pace of food aid delivery, as previous field assessments concluded and distribution reports indicate, WFP beneficiaries are expected to continue to receive half rations on a monthly basis or a full ration once every two months through September.

* FEWS NET classification is **IPC**-compatible with limited exceptions. IPC-compatible analysis follows key IPC protocols but does not necessarily reflect the consensus of national food security partners. As of IPC 3.0, the IPC no longer assesses the impact of food assistance on classification and thus no longer maps the (!). However, FEWS NET continues to produce food security maps inclusive of the (!) as well as maps compatible with IPC 3.0/3.1, which include the mapping of food security assistance bags. In rare cases, FEWS NET classification is IPC-aligned but not IPC-compatible. IPC-aligned analysis is evidence-based but some types of evidence required for IPC-compatibility were not available.

Key Message Update

This Key Message Update provides a high-level analysis of current acute food insecurity conditions and any changes to FEWS NET's latest projection of acute food insecurity outcomes in the specified geography. Learn more [here](#).